PixSort Interview — Emma Doyle

Conducted April 2026 · Bali (remote) · ~55 minutes

Role: Starting bag design at Adidas; ex-SMM (Brentford FC, TEDx, contract)

Location: LA (returned from London/Europe post-college)

Content: Personal food/travel Instagram, puppy Instagram

Not ICP | Organized Anomaly | Travel Creator Use Case Validated | Referrals Pending

STANDOUT INSIGHT

Emma is the rare person who already solved the problem — built a meticulous laptop-based folder system in college before studying abroad, because she knew she'd accumulate travel and food photos. Her phone has only ~2K photos at any time. She is the exception, not the rule.

Her most important quote on the broader market:

> *"Absolutely. Oh my gosh, I think every one of my friends, family members have like 40,000 photos that they've never moved or uploaded. Am I the only person that ever runs out of storage and then has to move it?"*

The moment she'd use PixSort: returning from a trip with everything pre-sorted. That's when her manual system gets replaced.

WORKFLOW

- **Phone = capture only.** Intentionally keeps it lean (~2K photos). Batch uploads every few weeks, then deletes everything.
- **Transfer:** AirDrop from phone or SD card → external hard drive (~5TB total accumulated over years).
- **Organization on laptop (Mac):** Hierarchical folder system — food → city → restaurant; travel; dog; work. Sort by date created after rough pass, then manually rename files (e.g. restaurant name) and move into final folder.
- **Food account posting:** Posts immediately on Instagram so the location tag captures the restaurant name. Later drops into laptop folder. Stopped "banking and scheduling" — too much effort for 300 followers.
- **Puppy account:** Much looser — one folder by date. Same clip could serve a GRWM, a recap, or something else, so she doesn't pre-sort.
- **Storage philosophy:** Hard drive = unlimited storage = freedom to create more. "Allows me to create more."
- **Side project:** Digitizing family VHS and Mini DV tapes — fully manual, AI sorting not possible due to lack of metadata in the format.

PAIN POINTS

- Batch upload + manual renaming process works but is time-consuming
- VHS digitization entirely manual — sees it as unsolvable with current AI for that format
- Phone-based albums never stuck — organizing on-the-go while traveling felt too disruptive, so she waits until home

LIVE APP TEST

- Downloaded TestFlight during the call
- **Bug:** App loaded only 12 photos out of ~500 (stuck at 2% for the entire call)
- Search/keyword identification working correctly — returned: food, eggs benedict, brunch, breakfast salad
- Albums not populating due to loading bug
- Understood the concept correctly on first pass
- Said she'd use it specifically **when going on a trip** — so that when she returns, content is already pre-sorted

ICP ASSESSMENT — SMM / ENTERPRISE CONTEXT

Emma worked at Brentford FC using **GreenFly**, an enterprise AI content platform for sports teams. GreenFly does what PixSort does but for B2B: auto-tags by player face, sponsor logo visibility, match/kit. Delivers tagged content directly to players and sponsors.

Her read on PixSort for company use: **privacy is the blocker.** Company content is far more sensitive. Each client's needs are too specific (which players, logos, game days) for a general product without deep customization — that's GreenFly's entire model.

Her takeaway: enterprise content sorting is a solved problem. PixSort's lane is personal/creator.

WHO SHE THINKS WOULD USE IT

- **Travel content creators** — location data + scene identification = auto-sorted on return from a trip
- **Travel + food creators** specifically — her first and strongest instinct
- Aligns directly with her own workflow and the moment she'd personally switch to it

KEY QUOTES

> *"It's paralyzing in the beginning, but once you start it clicks."*

> *"I know exactly where everything is in my computer at any given time. For me that gives me peace."*

> *"If I were to be going on a trip or something, that's when I would definitely use it."*

> *"Travel content creators... would be my first instinct."*

> *"For company data that's like way more sensitive — the security thing I think would be a concern."*

PRODUCT FLAGS FOR SPENCER

Flag	Source
Loading bug: stuck at 2% / 12 photos for entire session, albums never populated	Emma's live test
Search keyword identification working correctly while sorting was broken — partial functionality confirmed	Emma's live test

COMPETITOR NOTE

GreenFly — enterprise AI content tagging for sports teams. Face recognition, logo detection, match/kit sorting, direct delivery to players/sponsors. Not a direct competitor (different segment) but worth knowing it exists and that the enterprise version of this problem is already solved.

REFERRALS

- Will reach out to community managers and social media peers in her network
- No specific names confirmed yet — she'll send context once she hears back
- Note: many people she knows in social feel "pigeonholed as social media girl" and are pivoting — may have insights but may not be active content creators

> **ICP Verdict: Not ICP — organized anomaly with a desktop-first system.**
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> Emma solved the problem years ago. She doesn't have the accumulation problem PixSort addresses. However:
> (1) She strongly validates the **travel creator use case** — trip-return sorting is the exact moment she'd switch.
> (2) She confirms the scale of the unsolved problem: "every single one of my friends has 40,000 photos they've never organized."
> (3) Potential referral source via marketing/community manager network.
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> Priority: follow up once the bug is fixed so she can actually test. She's warm and willing.